

GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT (GDD)

Game Name: Papers, Thanks

Genre: Simulation / Point & Click

Game Elements: Document inspection, field cross-referencing, traveler interrogation, verdict issuing

Player: Single player

TECHNICAL SPECS

Technical Form: 2D graphics (flat). All visuals are drawn using Pygame primitives (rectangles, lines, polygons) and rendered text. Character portraits use pre-generated face images.

View: Fixed top-down desk view. The inspector's desk occupies the lower portion; the traveler booth window occupies the upper portion. The camera does not move.

Platform: PC

Language: Python 3.x

Device: PC (keyboard and mouse)

GAME PLAY

Game Play Outline

- The title screen greets the player; ENTER begins the game.
- A day briefing shows permitted nations and newly required documents before each shift.
- The player examines each traveler's documents within the shift timer.
- Investigation Mode (SPACE) lets the player click two fields to compare them across any documents.
- Interrogation Mode (Q) lets the player click a single field and receive a scripted traveler response.
- The player issues a verdict: A (Approve), D (Deny), or F (Detain).
- A 2-second stamp delay follows; input is blocked until the next traveler loads.
- When the timer expires the Family Screen appears: spend credits to feed each family member.
- Unfed members lose 1 HP. When all three reach 0 HP the game ends.
- There is no explicit win condition; the player survives as many days as possible.
- The challenge comes from spotting discrepancies under time pressure while earning enough credits to keep the family alive.

Key Features

- Progressive document system: four document types unlock over six days.
- Three-tier verdict system: Approve, Deny, or Detain with distinct rewards and penalties.
- Investigation cross-check: compare any two fields across documents by clicking them in sequence.
- Interrogation dialogue: scripted traveler responses keyed to the underlying flaw type.
- Family survival meta-game: credit budget management between every shift.
- Draggable document layout: all documents can be freely repositioned on the desk.
- Decreasing shift timers: 35 seconds on Day 1 down to 15 seconds from Day 8 onward.
- Dynamic in-game Rulebook: updates each day with permitted nations and current required documents.

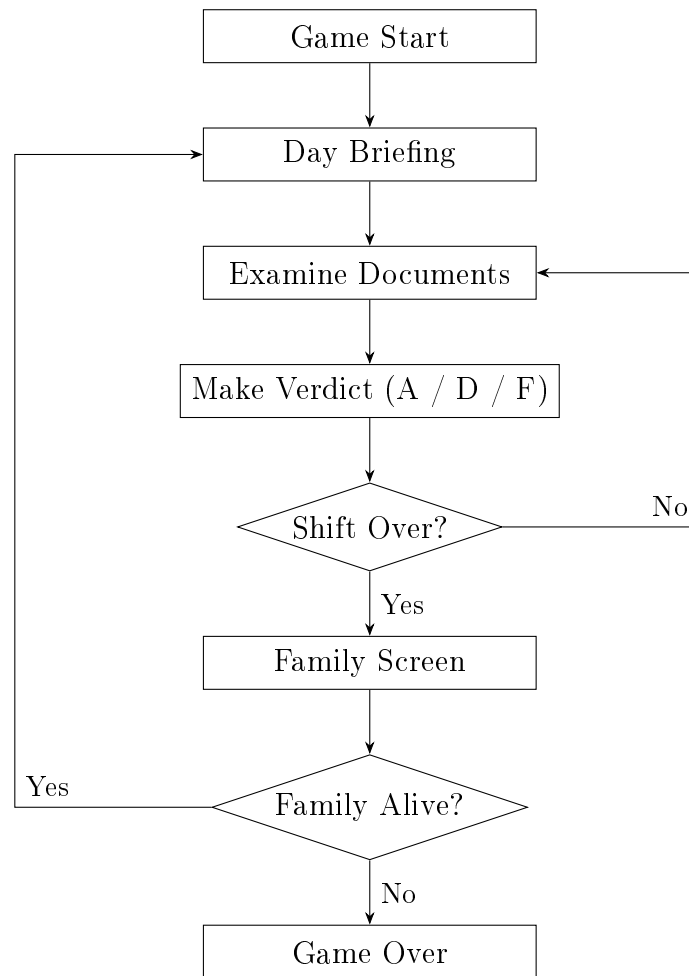
DESIGN DOCUMENT

Design Guidelines

Game Design Definitions

Term	Definition
Winning	No win state. The player survives as many days as possible.
Losing	All three family members reach 0 HP from starvation.
Core Loop	Inspect → Verify → Verdict → Earn Credits → Feed Family → Repeat.
Flaw	A discrepancy in a traveler's documents (e.g. expired passport, name mismatch, forged nation).
Verdict	The player's decision on a traveler: Approve, Deny, or Detain.
Detain	A special verdict for forged or fraudulent documents. Correct detentions earn a extra credit; wrongful detentions incur a double penalty.

Game Flowchart



PLAYER DEFINITION

Player Definitions

- **Credits:**The player's currency. Earned by correct verdicts; spent to feed the family.
- **Mistakes:**Incorrect verdicts per day. The first two each day are warnings (no penalty); further mistakes carry a credit deduction.
- **Family HP:**Each of the three family members starts at 3 HP. A member loses 1 HP each shift they are not fed.
- **Investigation Mode:**Click two document fields to cross-check their values. A banner reports match or mismatch.
- **Interrogation Mode:**Click one field to hear a scripted traveler response based on the underlying flaw type.
- **Actions:**Drag documents, open Rulebook, investigate fields, interrogate traveler, approve, deny, detain, feed family members.

Player Properties

Property	Change Mechanism	Feedback
Credits	+10 correct verdict; +15 detention bonus; penalty on excess mistakes	HUD counter
Mistakes	+1 per wrong verdict; resets each day	HUD counter
Family HP	-1 per unfed member after each shift	Heart icons
Day	+1 after Family Screen confirmed	HUD counter
Score	Calculated at game end from correct decisions, days survived, and living family members	End screen

Player Rewards

- **Correct verdict:**Correctly approve or deny: +10 credits.
- **Detention bonus:**Correctly detain a traveler with forged documents: +15 credits.
- **Warning leniency:**First two mistakes each day carry no credit penalty.
- **End-game score:**Final score computed as $(\text{correct} \times 20) - (\text{mistakes} \times 30) + (\text{days} \times 500) + (\text{alive members} \times 200)$

USER INTERFACE (UI)

Controls

Input	Action
A	Approve traveler
D	Deny traveler
F	Detain traveler
SPACE	Toggle Investigation Mode
Q	Toggle Interrogation Mode
Mouse click	Select document fields; click HUD buttons
Mouse drag	Reposition documents on the desk
ENTER	Confirm (Family Screen, Briefing)
ESC	Close the Rulebook overlay
R	Restart from the Start Screen

HUD Elements

- **Day counter:** Current day, shown in the top bar.
- **Processed counter:** Travelers handled this shift.
- **Credits counter:** Current credit balance.
- **Mistakes counter:** Incorrect verdicts this shift.
- **Shift timer:** Countdown bar top-right; turns red below 20%.
- **Queue indicator:** Silhouette row showing remaining travelers.
- **Family HP:** Three heart icon groups (Wife, Daughter, Son) bottom-right.

- **Verdict buttons:** Approve, Deny, Detain buttons bottom-center.
- **Rulebook widget:** Click to open the day's regulations overlay.
- **Stamp overlay:** Approve or Deny stamp fades in after each verdict.